Lesson 41 material: Word Forms

English Stage 2 (B2) · Unit 4: Words, Word Order and the Essay

Unit 18 Word Forms

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Original page, with audio and online exercises: https://harpercollege.pressbooks.pub/academic-writing-skills/chapter/unit-18word-forms/
Changes: formatted for print; exercise answers are in the study guide.

Unit 18 Word Forms

Learning Objectives

1. To learn the word forms of nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs as well as the strategies in using them correctly
2. To identify the different positions where nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs are located in sentences
3. To learn the common suffixes of nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs
4. To differentiate the uses of "-ing / -ed" ending adjectives as well as comparative/superlative nouns, adjectives, and adverbs
5. To understand and practice the different word forms through multiple examples and a variety of writing situations

I. Pretest

(Picture: Facebook and other apps on a phone screen)

Facebook and other apps on a phone screen

In the following ten sentences about the social media, some words are bold-faced and may contain mistakes in word form. If the bold-faced part in the sentence is correct, choose "correct". If not, choose the other answer. After you finish one sentence, you will get instant feedback on your answer before the next sentence. If you make mistakes, you can retry all the questions or see all the answers at the end of the pre-test.

EXERCISE

1. 1. On February 4, 2004, Mark Zukerberg and his friends launched Facebook **successful**.
a) correct b) successfully

2. 2. They **succeeded** in starting the first social media site.
a) correct b) success

3. 3. Their **successful** came from hard work and a strong interest in the computer technology.
a) correcct b) success

4. 4. Many people like Facebook, so it is a **success** social media site.
a) correct b) successful

5. 5. Many people think that Facebook is **more better** than other social media.
a) better b) correct

6. 6. Most messages and videos are **interesting**.
a) correct b) interested

7. 7. Young people learn to use Facebook **fastly**.
a) correct b) fast

8. 8. Elderly people may often be **confusing** by all the information there.
a) confused b) correct

9. 9. They learn how to use Facebook **more slow** than the younger generation.
a) correct b) more slowly

10. 10. Many elderly people believe that letters and phone calls are **best** ways to communicate.
a) correct b) the best

II. Strategies in Using Correct Word Forms

All words in English have their parts of speech, and the most common ones are nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs. Word forms are associated with parts of speech. For example, a "-tion" ending word is usually a noun, and an "-ly" ending word is usually an adverb.

Using the appropriate word form will ensure that the sentence is correct and that its meaning is clear. Here are some strategies:

1. Always learn vocabulary from the context.

Some words have multiple forms or parts of speech, with or without change in meaning. For example, the word "present" can be a verb and a noun with totally different meanings. Do not try to learn the word form in isolation; instead, put it in sentences so that you understand its meaning accurately.

2. Try not to translate the words into your native language.

Many words like "success, succeed, successful, successfully" may be used in similar ways in some languages but not in English. Therefore, understanding these words as they are positioned in English sentences is crucial in learning how to use them correctly.

3. Practice writing sentences with different word forms.

Consider them as word families. For example, take "success, succeed, successful, successfully" as one word family. Notice the changes in their suffixes[1]. In addition, if you try to write these sentences based on your own life stories, you may understand and remember them better.

4. As in studying any language, read as much as you can.

If possible, read out loud to listen to yourself, feel the movement of your tongue in the mouth, and hear what an English sentence sounds like. This will help improve the dexterity[2] of your tongue while articulating[3] sentences in English. It will also help you get more familiar with the sound of English.

III. Positions of Different Word Forms

The following are common places to find nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs in sentences.

Nouns – names of people, places, things, and ideas

1. Before a verb (as the subject of the verb)
   - Facebook is a social media site.
2. After a verb (as the object of the verb)
   - More and more people are using Facebook to post stories and opinions.
3. After a preposition
   - On Facebook, there are many images and videos.
4. After another noun
   - People like to show their birthday on the timeline page.
5. After an adjective
   - New features such as dark mode are very popular among young people.
6. After a determiner (article, possessive noun, possessive adjective, etc.)
   - One of the features is having three-dimensional images.
   - My cousin's posts are full of gaming videos. His videos are especially interesting.

Verbs – to show actions or states of being

(Picture: Instgram 3D icon concept)

Instgram 3D icon concept

1. After the subject (as the main verb of the sentence)
   - Some people like Facebook, and some others prefer Instagram.
2. After "to" (to + base verb, called infinitive)
   - Many people use both Facebook and Instagram to post their news.
3. After some causative verbs like "make, let, get"
   - Parents do not always let their young children use the social media.

Adjectives – to describe nouns

1. Before a noun
   - Instagram is becoming a more popular site for young people.
2. After a linking verb
   - Instagram is full of images and videos.
   - This is one of the reasons Instagram has grown popular.

Adverbs – to describe verbs, adjectives, other adverbs, or the whole sentences

1. Before or after a verb
   - News on the social media can quickly spread. It travels fast.
2. Before an adjective
   - There is both very good news and very bad news on the social media.
3. Before another adverb
   - My cousin's videos are posted extremely frequently on Facebook.
4. Before or after a whole sentence
   - Unfortunately, not everyone in my family likes my cousin's posts.
   - I do not always like his posts, either.

Exercise 1. Identify and highlight the part of speech required for each paragraph. Pay attention to their position in the sentence. Highlight only one word at a time. When you finish the entire exercise, you can retry or see all the answers. (To highlight, you position your computer curser on the verbs and right click.)

(Picture: two words: social media)

two words: social media

The first sentence is an example: Long before the social ***media…***

EXERCISE

Highlight all the nouns Long before social media , people relied mostly on TV, radio, and newspapers for current events. Personal news was shared through letters, postcards, and face-to-face conversations. That era has long gone. Highlight all the verbs In the 1990s, with the expansion of the Internet, emails gradually replaced many traditional forms of written communication. For example, many companies used emails for internal news and meeting

notifications. Personal emails also became popular. They were fast and free. Highlight all the adjectives The social networking sites appeared around early 2000s. Facebook was founded on February 4, 2004 by Mark Zukerberg and others at Harvard University. It quickly expanded. Anyone who was 13 years and older and had a valid email address in the United States and Canada could establish a Facebook account. Highlight all the adverbs Other social media sites soon quickly followed. Twitter started in the same year as Facebook. Others included WhatsApp in 2009, Instagram in 2010, Snapchat in 2011, and TikTok in 2017. The list continues. People are relying more and more on these social media for news and entertainment, especially for personal use. In many workplaces, emails and internal websites (called the Intranets) are probably still the most frequently used means for communication.

IV. Word Suffixes

Besides the location in a sentence, the suffix provides another way to show whether a word is a noun, a verb, an adjective, or an adverb. Here are some common suffixes.

Common Noun Suffixes

Suffixes	**Examples**									
(people)	-er/-or	-ee	-ist	-ian	-ant	employer, dancer, doctor, teacher	employee, interviewee[4], mentee, refugee[5]	artist, dentist, pianist, scientist	electrician, mathematician, musician, physician	accountant, assistant, consultant, immigrant
–ance/–ence	assistance, importance, difference, excellence									
–cy	accuracy, consistency, democracy, efficiency									
-hood	brotherhood, childhood, motherhood, parenthood									
-ion/-tion/-sion	application, decision, communication, religion									
-ment	achievement, argument, encouragement, government									
-ness	darkness, happiness, politeness, sadness									
-ship	dictatorship[6], friendship, relationship, scholarship									
-ty	activity, ability, beauty, possibility									

Common Verb Suffixes

Suffixes	**Examples**
-ate	activate, create, graduate, investigate
-en	darken[7], lighten[8], strengthen, threaten
-ify	identify, notify, simplify[9], verify[10]
-ize	criticize, hospitalize, realize, socialize

Common Adjective Suffixes

Suffixes	**Examples**
-able/-ible	acceptable, comfortable, responsible, valuable
-al	educational, equal, legal, social
-ant/-ent	dependent, different, efficient, important
-ary/-ery	angry, elementary, primary, secondary
-ful	beautiful, careful, helpful, useful
-ic	allergic, historic, electric, magic
-ing/-ed	amazing/amazed, boring/bored, exciting/excited, interesting/interested
-ish	childish[11], foolish, greenish, selfish
-ive	active, competitive, creative, expensive

-less	careless, helpless, selfless, useless
-ly	daily, friendly, lonely, silly
-ous	curious, dangerous, famous, religious
-y	funny, healthy, scary, rainy

Common Adverb Suffixes

Suffixes	**Examples**	
-ly	carefully, comfortably, happily, sadly	
others	frequency adverbs: always, often, sometimes, never ...	others: very, late, hard, fast, quite, well ...

The above charts show only the common suffixes and words you often use. There are many exceptions in English. It is not uncommon for the same suffix to be used for different parts of speech.

For example, not all words with the "-ly" ending are adverbs, and not all adverbs end with "-ly". The best approach is to look at the context.

1. It is hard to catch up with all the daily posts from my friends on the social media, so I do not read everything daily. (adjective, adverb)
2. My cousins update their information on Facebook fast; however, I am not a fast reader. (adverb, adjective)

Exercise 2. The following paragraph about the social media is taken from the pretest of this unit. Some words are bold-faced. Choose and highlight the part of speech related to each bold-faced word. Pay attention to its suffix and location in the sentence. When you finish the entire exercise, you can retry or see all the answers. (To highlight, you position your computer curser on the verbs and right click.)

The first sentence is an example:

On February 4, 2004, Mark Zuckerberg and his friends ***launched*** *(noun,* ***verb*** *, adjective, adverb) Facebook successfully.*

EXERCISE

Some Information about Facebook On February 4, 2004, Mark Zukerberg and his friends launched (noun, verb , adjective, adverb) Facebook successfully (noun, verb, adjective, adverb). They succeeded (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) in starting the first (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) social media site. Their success (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) came from hard work and a strong interest (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) in the computer technology. Many (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) people like Facebook, so it is a successful (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) social media site. They enjoy (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) posting their messages and videos on Facebook. Most messages and videos are (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) interesting. Young people learn to use Facebook fast (noun, verb, adjective, adverb), but elderly (noun, verb, adjective, adverb)people may often be confused by all the information there. They learn how to use Facebook more (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) slowly than the younger (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) generation. Many elderly people still like to share information (noun, verb, adjective, adverb) through letters and phone calls (noun, verb, adjective, adverb).

V. Difference Between "-ed" and "-ing" Ending Adjectives

"-ed" ending adjectives describe someone's feelings.

1. The young players were excited during the soccer game yesterday.
2. The parents were amused by the children's behaviors. Some children were running in the wrong direction, and some were kicking the ball into their opponents[12]' goal.
3. A mother in the audience was holding a baby. The baby was frightened by the loud noise from the soccer field. He certainly had no idea what was going on.

"-ing" ending adjectives describe the person or thing that produces those feelings.

1. The soccer game was very exciting yesterday.
2. The children's behaviors were amusing.
3. The loud noise from the soccer field was frightening to the baby.
4. All in all, the game was very interesting, and everyone was interested except the baby!

Exercise 3. One of the parents watching the above soccer game posted the following in her family Facebook chat group later that day. Select the correct word for each blank. When you finish the entire exercise, you can retry or see all the answers.

(Picture: toddlers playing soccer)

toddlers playing soccer

The first sentence is an example:

First of all, the weather was _____

*(****amazing*** *, amazed).*

EXERCISE

Today's Game There were several good surprises today. First of all, the weather was _____ (amazing , amazed). I had been worried that it would rain, but it didn't. There was a nice breeze. It was perfect for Matt's soccer game this afternoon. I was _____ (surprising, surprised) that the soccer cleats had become a bit too small for him. Matt is certainly growing very fast! Wait till I take him to the mall for a new pair. He'll be so _____

(fascinating, fascinated) to see all the new styles. The last surprise was the game. The parents are usually more anxious than the kids, but today all the kids were very hyper! The game lasted one and a half hours! Imagine how _____ (exciting, excited) and _____ (tiring, tired) everyone was! The kids were _____ (exhausting, exhausted), and the parents, too. For now, let me have a _____ (relaxing, relaxed) time in front of the TV … Check below for today's snapshots!

VI. Comparisons

Using nouns, adjectives, and adverbs in comparison is common. The following chart shows different word forms used in comparison.

(Picture: a happy family in the kitchen)

a happy family in the kitchen

Comparisons	**Examples**									
Showing similarity	**the same + noun + (as)**	My sister and I have the same hair color.	My hair has the same color as my sister's.	**as + adjective/adverb + as**	My hair is as long as my sister's.	My hair grows as quickly as my sister's.				
Comparing between 2	**(comparative forms)**	**more + plural count noun/singular noncount noun + than**	**fewer + plural count noun + than**	**less + singular noncount noun + than**	My brother watches more soccer games than my sister.	My sister watches fewer soccer games than my brother.	My brother has more time playing sports than my sister.	My sister has less time playing sports than my brother.	**1 – syllable adjective/adverb -er + than**	My sho tha bro
Comparing 3 or more	**(Superlative forms)**	**the most + plural count noun/singular noncount noun**	My sister collects the most stamps in my family.	My sister has the most patience of us all.	**the + 1-syllable adjective/adverb -est**	My sister is the shortest of all in my family.	**the + 2-syllable adjective ending in "y" - iest (Delete "y".)**	My sister is the easiest to talk with in my family.	**the + most/least + 3-syllable adjective**	**the mo + a wit**
Exceptions	bad – worse – worst	good / well – better – best	far – farther / further – farthest / furthest	little – less – least	many / much – more – most	I can speak English as well as my brother.	I speak English the best in my family.	I live farther from our childhood home than my brother.	Among the siblings, I live the farthest from our childhood home.	My the talk my

Exercise 4. The following sentences compare Android phones and iPhones . Choose the right word form for each sentence. You will get instant feedback on your answers. You may also retry the sentence or see the answer.

(Picture: a pile of cell phones)

a pile of cell phones

EXERCISE

1. 1. Android phones are as _____ as iPhones.

a) popular b) more popular c) the most popular

EXERCISE

1. 2. The battery life of Android phones is as _____ as that of iPhones.

a) longer b) long c) longest

EXERCISE

1. 3. Android phones are usually _____ than iPhones.

a) cheap b) cheaper c) the cheapest

EXERCISE

1. 4. Some people like iPhones even though they are _____.

a) expensiver b) more expensive c) the most expensive

EXERCISE

1. 5. People who like Android phones enjoy their "open" system. This means that this type of phone is able to work with _____ applications than iPhones.

a) many b) more c) the most

EXERCISE

1. 6. On the other hand, such "open" system might make the Androids _____.

a) less secure b) the least secure c) as secure as

EXERCISE

1. 7. As for updates, iPhones provide them_____ than Android phones.

a) as frequently as b) more frequently c) frequently

EXERCISE

1. 8. In many other areas such as video conferencing and cloud capabilities, both types of phones enjoy _____.

a) popular b) more popular c) the same level of popularity

EXERCISE

1. 9. Which type is _____, Android or iPhone? It depends on each person's preferences.

a) good b) better c) the best

EXERCISE

1. 10. Maybe one day in the future, Android phones and iPhones will have _____.

a) the same price b) as expensive as c) more expensive

VII. Unit Review Practice

Exercise 6. Choose and highlight the correct word form to complete each sentence about young children learning their heritage language. When you finish the entire exercise, you can retry or see all the answers.

Example:

(Picture: two words: social media)

"I love you" in different languages

Many young children do not receive much _____

(encourage, ***encouragement****) to speak their heritage*

language at home.

EXERCISE

1. Their parents often want them to learn English _____ (good, well) first.

2. Some parents think that the _____ (different, differences) in languages may confuse their children.

3. However, speaking the heritage language in the family can _____ (help, helpful) preserve the home culture and promote communication.

4. It is also a way to show _____ (respect, respectful) for the elderly who usually cannot speak English.

5. For the youngsters, it may be _____ (fun, funny) to learn their heritage language even though it can be very _____ (challenge, challenging).

6. Some young children would rather use their time for other activities, but some others learn their heritage language _____ (happy, happily).

Exercise 7. Choose the correct word form in each group of sentences. Drag the correct answer to the box. You will get instant feedback on your choices. After each set of questions, you may retry or see all the answers.

EXERCISE

1. My baby's favorite _____ is sleeping.

2. John leads an _____ life. He is always busy.

3. My friend is _____ looking for a job these days.

EXERCISE

1. She dressed the baby very _____ before taking him home from the hospital.

2. Be _____ if you are walking alone at night.

3. Did she really _____ about him?

4. The child _____ stepped on a piece of broken glass. Thankfully, he was not hurt.

5. This box is full of glass objects. Handle it with _____.

6. Students often make _____ mistakes in tests. That is why they need to check all the answers _____ before submitting their tests.

EXERCISE

1. This disease could be _____. Get medical help right away!

2. The child has never seen a _____ body before.

3. Many people like to travel before they _____.

4. The newspaper reported the celebrity's _____ yesterday.

EXERCISE

1. There will be a _____ music performance in the auditorium tonight. Some of my classmates are going to perform.

2. My _____ is getting easier with the help of modern appliances like washing machine.

3. There was a _____ discussion yesterday about the benefits of not having a cell phone.

4. They _____ with their uncle's family.

5. Is that spider _____ or dead?

EXERCISE

1. I need _____ carrying the box upstairs. Who can _____ me?

2. The librarians have been very _____ in finding the book for me.

3. When her car broken down in the middle of a country road and her cell phone ran out of power, she felt so _____.

EXERCISE

1. Tom is _____ to Mary. Their _____ is a happy one.

2. Many young people today are not so eager to _____ in their 20s.

EXERCISE

1. Although the trip was dangerous, they arrived home _____.

2. _____ is the most important when you drive.

3. That boat is very _____. Do not be afraid to get in.

4. As soon as they arrived at the hotel, they put their passports and money in the _____ in the room.

Exercise 8. Find and correct eight more word form errors in the following paragraph about housing (not including the example). The first is an example.

A Condo or a House?

At certain point in their lives, many people need to decide: to buy a condo or to buy a house? Which choice is ***~~best~~ (better)*** for them? It can be hard to decide. A condo offers many convenient. It is often more cheap than a house, and it usually has an association office to help the residents with various issues. Besides, some condos have a swimming pool and a children's playground. These facilities help families meet each other and have fun together. On the other hand, a house is definite larger and more comfortably than a condo. Each person in the family can enjoyment more privacy as well. Most houses have a backyard, too. People also have the free to keep pets in their house, but pets may not be allowed in a condo. A condo or a house? This could be a difficulty choice. It depends on what people think is most suitable for them.

Exercise 9. Follow the examples to write your own sentences with the words given.

Examples:

*Lying on the beach on a summer evening is **relaxing**.*

*I feel **relaxed** when I lie on the beach on a summer evening.*

boring/bored, disappointing/disappointed, embarrassing/embarrassed, confusing/confused, surprised/surprising, tiring/tired, fascinating/fascinated

Exercise 10. Choose one of the topics and write at least eight sentences of comparison. .

1. two or more social media sites
2. two or more phones
3. two or more members of your family
4. two or more vacations you have had
5. two or more books you have read.
6. Two or more kinds of food

NSNT Practice

(Picture: a pen writing in a notebook)

a pen writing in a notebook

Go to **The NSNT Free Writing Approach and Additional Weekly Prompts for Writing** in Appendix A. *(Open Appendix A here.)* Choose two topics that you have not written about. You may start with the NSNT approach. Then revise and edit your paragraphs. Pay attention to the use of word forms. You are encouraged to share your writing with your partner and help each other improve.

EXERCISE

Writing task: You may write in your notebook or in the box below. (Warning: Once you leave this page, you will lose what you have written in the box.) .

Vocabulary Review

(Picture: a page in a dictionary)

a page in a dictionary

The words here have appeared in this unit. The best way to learn them is to guess the meaning of each word from the context. Then hover your computer mouse over the number beside each word to check its meaning and part of speech. These words are also listed in the footnote area at the end of each unit.

Here, you can use the flashcards below to review these words.

EXERCISE

- **suffix**: noun, something such as "ly" or "er" added to the end of a word
- **dexterity**: noun, the ability to move freely and naturally
- **articulate**: verb, speak clearly
- **interviewee**: noun, the person being interviewed
- **refugee**: noun, a person who has to leave his or her country because of politics, religion, war, natural disaster, etc.
- **dictatorship**: noun, a form of government where the leader has absolute control
- **darken**: verb, make or become dark
- **lighten**: verb, to make or become light
- **simplify**: verb, make something simple
- **verify**: verb, check, confirm
- **childish**: adjective, immature, thinking or acting like a child
- **opponent**: noun, a person from the opposite team

Summary

1. Word forms are associated with nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs.
2. Each word form has some common suffixes.
3. Some of the strategies in using word forms correctly are:
   - Learning from the context.
   - Do not translate into native languages.
   - Practice writing sentences with different word forms.
   - Read as much as possible.
4. Nouns are names of people, places, things, and ideas. They usually appear:
   - Before or after a verb
   - After a preposition
   - Before or after another noun
   - After an adjective
   - After a determiner
5. Verbs are used to show actions or states of being. They usually appear:
   - After the subject
   - After “to”
   - After some causative verbs
6. Adjectives describe nouns. They usually appear:
   - Before a noun
   - After a link verb
7. Adverbs describe verbs, adjectives, other adverbs, or the entire sentences. They usually appear:
   - Before or after a verb
   - Before an adjective
   - Before another adverb
   - Before or after the whole sentence
8. Adjectives with an “-ed” ending usually describe a person’s feeling.
9. Adjectives with an “-ing” ending usually describe the person/thing that causes the feeling.
10. Different word forms are used in comparison.
    - To show similarity: the same ... as, as...as
    - Compare between the two: -er than, more ... than
    - Compare among three or more: the -est, the most ...

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1. suffix: noun, something such as "ly" or "er" added to the end of a word ↲
2. dexterity: noun, the ability to move freely and naturally ↲
3. articulate: verb, speak clearly ↲
4. interviewee: noun, the person being interviewed ↲
5. refugee: noun, a person who has to leave his or her country because of politics, religion, war, natural disaster, etc. ↲
6. dictatorship: noun, a form of government where the leader has absolute control ↲
7. darken: verb, make or become dark ↲
8. lighten: verb, make or become light ↲
9. simplify: verb, make something simple ↲
10. verify: verb, check, confirm ↲
11. childish: adjective, immature, thinking or acting like a child ↲
12. opponent: noun, a person from the opposite team ↲